

Lamb of God

Jesus became the Lamb that takes away our sins once and for all.



Isaac spoke to his father Abraham. "Father!" he said. "Here I am," he replied. Isaac continued, "Here are the fire and the wood, but where is the sheep for the burnt offering?" "My son," Abraham answered, "God will provide the sheep for the burnt offering." Then the two walked on together. - Genesis 22:7-8



Sacrifice for Sin

Read the following passage of scripture and underline all the sins Jesus talks about. He came to redeem us from the bondage of all this evils.

Mark 7: 17 - 23

When he got home away from the crowd his disciples questioned him about the parable. He said to them, "Are even you likewise without understanding? Do you not realize that everything that goes into a person from outside cannot defile, since it enters not the heart but the stomach and passes out into the latrine?" (Thus he declared all foods clean.)

"But what comes out of a person, that is what defiles. From within people, from their hearts, come evil thoughts, unchastity, theft, murder, adultery, greed, malice, deceit, licentiousness, envy, blasphemy, arrogance, folly. All these evils come from within and they defile."



Did You Know?

Jesus being the Lamb of God was foreshadowed many times in Scripture. For example: the saving blood of lambs on the doorposts of the Israelite slaves during the plague of Egypt, God's provision of a sacrificial ram when Abraham was asked to offer up his son Issac, the sacrificial system set up in the Law of Moses, and the prophecy in Isaiah about the Messiah.

Reflection Questions



Pause to reflect on Jesus.

In the Mass (“The Breaking of the Bread”) we remember Jesus’s great love for us in offering himself as a physical sacrifice, shedding his own blood for our sake. How does knowing someone gave their life for you change the way you see yourself? Do you know how loved you are?

Jesus’ sacrifice of blood is an unparalleled act of love in human history, but let us also pause to consider what it was like for God the Father to offer his Son for us, for Mary, Mother of God to watch her Son be hurt for our sake. What would be harder for you, to sacrifice yourself or a loved one?

Response of Thanksgiving

Use your reflections to guide a prayer to the Father and the Son.

Take a solemn moment to thank Jesus and the Father for the gift of salvation through Christ’s most precious blood. Use your own words or a favorite devotional prayer.

Guided Imaginative Prayer

Follow the prompt to enter into imaginative prayer.

Imagine yourself at the foot of the cross through Our Lady’s eyes. It’s cold and windy. The sun is hidden, though it is 3 o’clock in the afternoon. Your eyes are burning with tears, but you keep your eyes on your Son as he takes his final breaths. He is unrecognizably disfigured, but you hold memory of him as he was just days before while gazing on his bloody wounds. You remember him playing with wooden toys in the living room and when you knew you he was growing in your womb. You remember how proud you were when he began to teach, and how your family had fled to Egypt to protect him as a baby. You wish you could hold him again, but with great love for the world, you watch and wait on God, as you’ve always done.



REFERENCES:

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